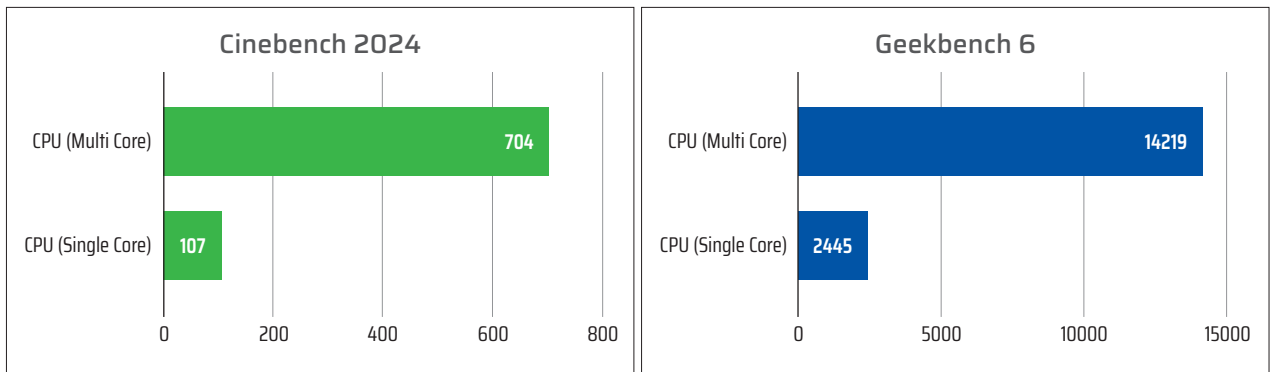




titles at comfortable frames based on these scores.

In terms of emissions, the Elitebook Ultra operates quietly, with barely audible fan noise. However, it also runs pretty warm, especially during intense workloads. The hot spot near the WASD keys can reach over 40 degrees Celsius, while the right side remains significantly cooler, by almost 10 degrees Celsius.

Battery

During our video loop test, the HP Elitebook Ultra lasted a total of 792 minutes, which is a little over 13 hours. Battery life is solid, and should easily last you a day without needing to charge.

HP AI Companion

HP's latest AI-powered app, the HP AI Companion, aims to redefine productivity by integrating artificial intelligence directly into its laptops. Touted as a smart assistant for users, it promises to make tasks like document analysis, system optimization, and information

retrieval more efficient, but how well does it live up to these claims?

While the HP AI Companion introduces some interesting features, it falls short of delivering the transformative experience one might expect. The app is divided into four main features: Ask, Analyze, Discover, and Perform. The "Ask" feature functions as a ChatGPT-like chatbot, but with the ability to provide only eight follow-ups for a query. It does well in directing users to resources but lacks functionality like generating graphs. On the brighter side, the "Analyze" feature is a standout, allowing users to upload documents and create a repository of information. The AI can retrieve, compare, and even summarise data, making it useful for managing large files, though it's limited to 100MB in storage.

"Discover" offers recommendations for other AI tools, while "Perform" takes care of the system by monitoring hardware performance and downloading drivers automatically. How-

ever, there's a catch: despite marketing itself as an on-device AI solution, the Companion requires an active internet connection and a logged-in HP account to work, which might be a letdown for users looking for a seamless offline experience.

While it's built on GPT-4o and is still in beta, the app feels like a work in progress, especially when compared to Microsoft Copilot, which comes pre-installed on many machines. In some cases, the HP AI Companion offers more detailed answers, but overall, its feature set lacks the impact to truly set it apart. HP is on the right track with the idea, but the execution needs refinement to make the AI Companion a must-have tool.

HP Elitebook Ultra Verdict

The HP Elitebook Ultra G1q 14 presents a promising entry into the world of Windows on ARM, but it faces stiff competition from Intel and AMD alternatives. While it's not a bad machine, its features and performance do not sufficiently differentiate it from well-established rivals, even within HP's own lineup.

At its current price point, which is pretty pricey, the Elitebook Ultra struggles to justify itself, especially when many competitors offer superior compatibility and performance. If Qualcomm and PC manufacturers aim to convince users to transition to Windows on ARM, they need to deliver more compelling advantages. While this device is a step in the right direction, it has a long journey ahead to truly compete in the market. **A**

